

Alivia R. Cochran

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Education

2026 (Expected) Ph.D. Economics, University of Wyoming
2022 M.S. Economics, University of Wyoming
2020 B.A. Economics, *Summa Cum Laude*, with Minors in Mathematics and Spanish, University of Northern Colorado

Experience

2021 – Present **Research Assistant for Professor Charles F. Mason, University of Wyoming**
– Serve as Associate Editor for the journal *Economics of Energy and Environmental Policy*
– Conduct research for a grant through the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation to assess policy strategies for scaling carbon capture and storage in the United States
– Construct a theoretical model based on real options for the investment decision in carbon capture, utilization, and storage (CCUS)
– Solve the model via numerical simulation using MATLAB

2024 – Present **Graduate Student Engagement Committee member, Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE)**
– Conduct and facilitate panels for graduate students
– Host the Emerging Professionals Social at AERE-affiliated conferences

2025 **Guest Speaker for ECON 620 – Industrial Organization and the Energy Sector, Rice University**
– Teach Economics Master's students for a 90-minute class about CCUS
– Explain the concepts of mothballing and uncertain profits and policies

2023 **Instructor of Record for ECON 1010 – Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Wyoming**
– Teach 150 students on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays from 9:00-9:50 a.m.
– Prepare and deliver class lectures, create exams, and tutor during office hours

2023 **Intern - Student Trainee Economist, Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (FERC)**
– Create an interactive map using R that shows company-level receipt and delivery points at physical natural gas hubs along a pipeline
– Construct a dashboard using Power BI that shows number of physical and financial transactions on each natural gas hub for a selected company and period

2020 – 2021 **EconHelp Tutor, University of Wyoming**
– Tutor every undergraduate economics course offered during the 2020-2021 academic year
– Tutor 20 hours per week

2018 – 2020 **Tutorial Services Peer Tutor, University of Northern Colorado**
– College Reading and Learning Association Level 2 certified tutor in 100-300 level economics, mathematics, and Spanish courses

Research Papers

1. *The optimal decision to invest in carbon capture, utilization, and storage (CCUS): An investment under uncertainty framework* (with C. F. Mason)
– Presented at seven conferences | Average number of attendees at each presentation: 40
2. *Impacts of state-level policies on wind farm investments*
– Examine how policies from each state affect the number of wind farms that are built using Stata
3. *Firm's optimal decision to invest in a wind farm using an investment under uncertainty framework*
– Presented at four conferences | Average number of attendees at each presentation: 40
4. *The value of managing a common pool resource* (with J. F. Shogren, I. Zapata-Morán, N. Zafar, and S. Mukherjee)
– Survey the general public's preferences for institutions that manage a common pool resource using Qualtrics

Honors and Awards

2024 Shelby Gerking Graduate Student Award in Economics, University of Wyoming
2023 William E. Morgan Graduate Student Award in Economics, University of Wyoming
2021 Outstanding First-Year PhD Student in Economics Award, University of Wyoming
2019 Academic Achievement in Economics Award, University of Northern Colorado

Skills

Computing Skills R, MATLAB, Stata, Mathematica, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, ArcGIS, Power BI, Microsoft Office
Languages English (native), Spanish (proficient)